

StockKeep

Shop Inventory & Stock Tracking System

User Manual

User_Manual.pdf — Standalone End-User Guide

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Screenshots could not be captured for this edition because no browser automation tool was available in the environment used to prepare this documentation. Every screen is marked with a clearly labelled placeholder, e.g. [INSERT SCREENSHOT --- Dashboard], at the exact point a real screenshot should be inserted. No screenshot has been fabricated. The student should replace each placeholder with a real capture from a running instance before submission.

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1. Introduction

StockKeep is a web-based inventory and stock tracking tool for a single small shop. This manual explains how to access the system, log in, and use every feature available to shop staff: dashboard, inventory management, stock movements, sales recording, supplier management, reports, settings, and the AI assistant. It is written for a non-technical shop staff audience.

2. System Requirements

- A modern desktop or mobile web browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox, or Safari, recent version).
- An internet connection to reach the deployed StockKeep URL, and (optionally) for AI chat / AI insight features to reach Google's Gemini service.
- No software installation is required — StockKeep runs entirely in the browser.

3. Accessing the Application

Open the StockKeep web address provided by your administrator — the live deployment for this project is at <https://ai-stock-keep-tracker.vercel.app/> (see `Deployment_and_Source_Links.txt` for full details). You will land on the **Login** screen.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Login Screen]

4. Login

1. Enter the shop passcode into the passcode field.
2. Press **Unlock** (or press Enter).
3. If the passcode is correct, you are taken to the Dashboard. If incorrect, an error message is shown and you may try again.

Note: the current build uses a single shared passcode for the whole shop — there are no individual staff logins. The initial passcode is **1234**; change it under Settings after your first login (Section 15). The passcode is hashed and stored securely, and the Settings screen's passcode field is now the real, working way to change it.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Login Error State]

5. Dashboard

After logging in you land on the **Dashboard** tab, showing:

- Key figures (KPIs): total revenue, current inventory value, total item count, units sold.
- A revenue trend chart for the last 14 days.
- A breakdown of inventory by category.
- Recent activity (latest stock movements and sales).
- An AI-generated summary/insight of the shop's current state (or a rule-based summary if the AI service is unavailable — you will not see an error either way).

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Dashboard]

6. Inventory Management

6.1 Viewing Inventory

Select the **Inventory** tab to see the full item list: name, SKU, category, quantity, price, and status (in stock / low stock / out of stock). Use the search box to filter by name or SKU, and the category dropdown to filter by category.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Inventory List]

6.2 Adding Items

1. From the Inventory tab, select **Add Item**.
2. Fill in the item name (required), category, starting quantity, low-stock threshold, price, and optionally a location, description, expiry date, and supplier.
3. Select **Save**. The system automatically generates a unique SKU (e.g., SKU-013) — you do not need to enter one.
4. If any field is invalid (e.g., a negative quantity), you will see a validation message and the item will not be saved.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Add Item Form]

6.3 Viewing Item Detail

Select any item in the Inventory list to open its **Item Detail** view, showing its full information, supplier, complete stock-movement history, and sales history for that item.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Item Detail]

6.4 Editing and Deleting Items

From the Item Detail view you can edit any field or delete the item entirely. Deleting an item also removes its associated stock-movement and sale history (cascade delete).

7. Stock-In

To record newly received stock:

1. Open the item's Detail view.
2. Select **Stock In**.
3. Enter the quantity received and select **Confirm**.
4. The item's quantity increases immediately and a Stock-In entry is added to its movement history.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Stock In Dialog]

8. Stock-Out

To record stock leaving for a reason other than a sale (e.g., damage, internal use):

1. Open the item's Detail view.
2. Select **Stock Out**.
3. Enter the quantity and select **Confirm**.
4. The system will **not** allow a Stock-Out that would take the item's quantity below zero — you will see an error message if you try.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Stock Out Dialog]

9. Recording a Sale

Use the **Sales** tab to record a completed sale:

1. Select the item and enter the quantity sold and the unit price (defaults to the item's listed price).
2. Select **Record Sale**.
3. The system checks that enough stock is available — if you try to sell more than is in stock, the sale is rejected with a clear message.
4. On success, the item's quantity is reduced automatically and the sale appears in the Sales list and in the item's history.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Sales Tab]

10. Viewing Inventory (Search, Filter, Low Stock)

The **Low Stock** tab lists every item at or below its configured reorder threshold, so staff can quickly see what needs reordering without scanning the full inventory list.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Low Stock View]

11. Stock Movement / History

Every Stock-In, Stock-Out, and sale-triggered stock change is recorded as a **StockMovement** and is visible on the relevant item's Detail page, most recent first, each entry showing the type (IN/OUT), quantity, and timestamp.

12. Managing Suppliers

The **Suppliers** tab lists all suppliers with the number of items linked to each. Select **Add Supplier** to create a new one (name is required; contact, phone, email, and address are optional). Existing suppliers can be edited or removed from the same screen.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Suppliers Tab]

13. Reports

The **Reports** tab shows total inventory value, a category-by-category value breakdown, and a list of “dead stock” — items that have not sold recently — to help identify slow-moving inventory.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Reports Tab]

14. Settings

The **Settings** tab lets you update the store name, toggle low-stock email notifications, set the notification email address, and (if using email alerts) enter a Resend API key.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Settings Tab]

Note: the passcode field is write-only for security — it always starts blank and never shows the current passcode. Leave it blank to keep your current passcode, or type a new one (minimum 4 characters) and save to change it; the new passcode takes effect immediately for future logins. The same applies to the Resend API key field.

15. AI Assistant

An AI chat panel is available from the Dashboard, letting you ask natural-language questions such as “What’s low on stock?” or “What was our revenue this week?” If the AI service is temporarily unavailable, StockKeep automatically falls back to a rule-based answer computed from your real data, so the assistant always responds — it may just be less conversational in that case.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - AI Chat Panel]

Item Detail pages may also show an AI-generated stockout forecast (estimated days until the item runs out, and a suggested reorder quantity), again with an automatic fallback calculation if the AI call fails.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - AI Forecast Panel]

16. Validation / Error Messages

StockKeep validates your input before saving. Common messages you may see:

Message (example)	Meaning	What to do
“Name is required”	The item/supplier name field was left blank	Enter a name
“Cannot remove N units. Current stock is M. Stock cannot drop below 0.”	A Stock-Out or sale would take quantity negative	Reduce the quantity, or restock first
“Insufficient stock! Requested N units, but current stock is M.”	A sale exceeds available stock	Reduce the sale quantity
“Incorrect passcode, try again”	The wrong passcode was entered at login	Re-enter the correct passcode

17. Logout

Select **Logout** from the navigation menu at any time to end your session. You will be returned to the Login screen, and will need to re-enter the passcode to access the system again.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT - Logout Confirmation]

18. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely Cause	Suggested Fix
Can't log in with a passcode that used to work	Someone changed it under Settings (the passcode field is the real, working source of truth)	Ask whoever last updated Settings, or have an administrator reset it
Locked out after several wrong attempts, seeing "Too many attempts"	Login is rate-limited (5 attempts per 5 minutes per network address) to block brute-force guessing	Wait for the cooldown shown in the error message, then try again with the correct passcode
Page redirects back to Login unexpectedly	Session cookie expired (7-day limit) or was cleared by the browser	Log in again
AI chat gives a short, generic answer instead of a detailed one	The AI (Gemini) service call failed and the rule-based fallback answered instead — this is expected, safe behaviour, not a crash	Try again later, or check the Gemini API key/model configuration with your developer
Adding an item with a negative or zero quantity/threshold shows a clear validation message and the item is not saved	Expected behaviour — the form correctly rejected invalid input	Re-enter a valid (zero or positive) value

19. Frequently Encountered Problems

1. **“I can’t find a way to view more than the most recent 100 sales.”** This is a known limitation ([Technical_Debt_Plan.pdf](#), TD-10) — pagination is not yet implemented.
2. **“The AI chat/forecast still gives a generic-sounding answer sometimes.”** If the Gemini service is briefly unavailable, StockKeep automatically uses a rule-based fallback so the assistant never fails outright — this is expected, safe behaviour, not a bug.
3. **“I don’t see a separate Admin login.”** The current build has one shared passcode and no distinct admin/staff roles — every logged-in user has the same access.

20. Contact / Support

For issues with this system, contact: **[SUPPORT CONTACT — TO BE PROVIDED BY STUDENT]**